Persist Week of October 3, 2026

REMINDER: Persist is no longer accessible through ATOM. To continue using Persist, you must log in through our new app. If you have not received your login instructions or are experiencing any issues, please contact us at support@functional-bodybuilding.com. We will continue to send a PDF version of training in our Persist only weekly newsletters.

This document may be created in advance of edits to the ongoing tracks in Persist, so while we try to minimize these discrepancies as much as possible, the version displayed in our app is always the most up to date. As always, please reach out using the chat bubble in our FBB app or on our website at https://functional-bodybuilding.com if you have any questions about the programming. It may be helpful to look over the week ahead to make sure your questions are all answered in time for your workout.

Pump Lift 5x
- Monday, October 5th, 2026
- Tuesday, October 6th, 2026
- Wednesday, October 7th, 2026
- Thursday, October 8th, 2026
- Friday, October 9th, 2026
- Saturday, October 10th, 2026
- Sunday, October 11th, 2026

Pump Lift 4x
- Monday, October 5th, 2026
- Tuesday, October 6th, 2026
- Wednesday, October 7th, 2026
- Thursday, October 8th, 2026
- Friday, October 9th, 2026
- Saturday, October 10th, 2026
- Sunday, October 11th, 2026

Pump Lift 3x
- Monday, October 5th, 2026
- Tuesday, October 6th, 2026
- Wednesday, October 7th, 2026
- Thursday, October 8th, 2026
- Friday, October 9th, 2026
- Saturday, October 10th, 2026

- Sunday, October 11th, 2026
- Pump Condition 5x
  - Monday, October 5th, 2026
  - Tuesday, October 6th, 2026
  - Wednesday, October 7th, 2026
  - Thursday, October 8th, 2026
  - Friday, October 9th, 2026
  - Saturday, October 10th, 2026
  - Sunday, October 11th, 2026
- Pump Condition 4x
  - Monday, October 5th, 2026
  - Tuesday, October 6th, 2026
  - Wednesday, October 7th, 2026
  - Thursday, October 8th, 2026
  - Friday, October 9th, 2026
  - Saturday, October 10th, 2026
  - Sunday, October 11th, 2026
- Pump Condition 3x
  - Monday, October 5th, 2026
  - Tuesday, October 6th, 2026
  - Wednesday, October 7th, 2026
  - Thursday, October 8th, 2026
  - Friday, October 9th, 2026
  - Saturday, October 10th, 2026
  - Sunday, October 11th, 2026
- Perform
  - Monday, October 5th, 2026
  - Tuesday, October 6th, 2026
  - Wednesday, October 7th, 2026
  - Thursday, October 8th, 2026
  - Friday, October 9th, 2026
  - Saturday, October 10th, 2026
  - Sunday, October 11th, 2026
- Minimalist
  - Monday, October 5th, 2026
  - Tuesday, October 6th, 2026
  - Wednesday, October 7th, 2026

Thursday, October 8th, 2026
Friday, October 9th, 2026
Saturday, October 10th, 2026
Sunday, October 11th, 2026

Pump Lift 5x

Monday, October 5th, 2026

Week 1 Day 1 - Persist PUMP LIFT 5x

A) Daily Focus Notes:
Back Squat
Three seconds in the bottom is longer than it sounds. You cannot bounce out of a position you have been sitting in, so the pause shows whether your bottom is somewhere you can hold or just somewhere you pass through. Keep your air in and your back tight for the whole count, because once the brace goes the bar settles into you and standing up gets much harder.
Short on time? Remove Finisher

B) Warmup (8 min):
3 Rounds
1. 90 sec Cardio of Choice
1. Goblet Heel Sits; 10 reps
1. Ring Assisted Cossack Squat; 6 reps/side

C) Strength Intensity (15 min):
Back Squat
3 Working Sets; rest 2-3 min
Warm-Up Set - 5 reps @33X1 Tempo - Easy
Warm-Up Set - 5 reps @33X1 Tempo - Easy
Working Set 1 - 5 reps @33X1 Tempo - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 5 reps @33X1 Tempo - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - 5 reps @33X1 Tempo - RPE 9
RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

D) Strength Intensity 2 (12-15 min):
Back Rack Reverse Lunge
3 Working Sets; rest 75-90 sec between all sides and sets

Warm-Up Set - 10 reps/side @20X0 Tempo - Easy
Working Set 1 - 10 reps/side @20X0 Tempo - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 10 reps/side @20X0 Tempo - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - 10 reps/side @20X0 Tempo - RPE 9
RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

E) Strength Balance (12 min):
3 sets
1. Assisted Nordic Hamstring Curl or BC Gliding Hamstring Curl; 8 reps @30X0 Tempo
rest 60 sec
2. Russian KB Swing; 10-15 reps
rest 60-90 sec and back to 1.
Loading Note:
Perform 1-2 warmup sets to determine starting weight. Aim for each set to be close to failure.

F) Finisher (10 min):
2-3 sets
1. Hollow Body Hold; 30 sec
rest 30 sec
2. Toes Elevated Donkey Calf Raise; 10-20 reps @20X0 Tempo
rest 60 sec and back to 1.
Loading Note:
Perform 1 warmup set. Aim for each set to be close to form failure.

G) Cooldown (5 min):
1-2 sets
1. Foot Elevated Hamstring Stretch; 30 sec/side
1. Dynamic Couch Stretch; 30 sec/side
1. Hip Sleeper Stretch; 30 sec/side

Tuesday, October 6th, 2026

Week 1 Day 2 - Persist PUMP LIFT 5x

A) Daily Focus Notes:
Close Grip Bench Press
Bringing your hands in shifts the work from the chest to the triceps and keeps your elbows tucked closer to your ribs. Expect to use less weight than your normal bench, that is the point. The last set is max reps at your first working weight, so leave something in the tank for it.
Short on time? Remove Finisher

B) Warmup (8 min):
2 min Cardio of Choice
3 Sets
1. 15 sec Cardio Sprint
1. Plank to Alternating Toe Touch; 6 reps/side
1. Half Kneeling Cable or Band Row; 10 reps/side

C) Strength Intensity (12 min):
Close Grip Bench Press
4 Working Sets; rest 2 min
Warm-Up Set - 10 reps @20X1 Tempo - Easy
Working Set 1 - 8 reps @20X1 Tempo - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 8 reps @20X1 Tempo - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - 8 reps @20X1 Tempo - RPE 9
Working Set 4 - Max Unbroken reps @20X1 Tempo - RPE 10 - Set 1 weight.
RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

D) Strength Intensity 2 (8 min):
Incline Dumbbell Bench Press
3 Working Sets; rest 75-90 sec between sets
Warm-Up Set - 10 reps @21X1 Tempo - Easy
Working Set 1 - 10 reps @21X1 Tempo - RPE 8
Working Set 2 - 10 reps @21X1 Tempo - RPE 9
Working Set 3 - Max Unbroken reps @21X1 Tempo - RPE 10 - Set 1 weight.
RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

E) Strength Balance (10 min):
3 sets
1. Incline DB Chest Fly; 10 reps @30X0 Tempo
rest 30 sec
2. Barbell Skullcrushers; 10 reps @30X0 Tempo
rest 90 sec and back to 1.
Loading Note:
Perform 1-2 warmup sets to determine starting weight. Aim for each set to be close to failure.

F) Finisher (8 min):
2-3 sets
1. 1 1/4 Pushup; 6-10 reps @20X0 Tempo

rest 30 sec
2. Head Support DB Rear Delt Fly; 12-15 reps @30X0 Tempo
rest 60 sec and back to 1.
Loading Note:
Perform 1 warmup set. Aim for each set to be close to form failure.

G) Cooldown (5 min):
1-2 sets
1. Scorpion Chest Stretch; 30 sec/side
1. Banded Single Arm Behind the Back Stretch; 30 sec/side
1. Passive Hang; 30 sec

Wednesday, October 7th, 2026

Week 1 Day 3 - Persist PUMP LIFT 5x

A) Daily Focus Notes:
Romanian Deadlift
The RDL is a hinge, not a squat. Push your hips back, keep the bar dragging close to your legs, and stop when you feel the stretch behind your knees. Three seconds down on every rep is what builds the hamstrings here, so do not rush the lowering.
Short on time? Remove Finisher

B) Warmup (8 min):
2 min Cardio of Choice
3 Sets
1. Banded Goodmorning; 10-15 reps
1. DB Chainsaw Row; 6-8 reps/side

C) Strength Intensity (12 min):
Romanian Deadlift
3 Working Sets; rest 2-3 min
Warm-Up Set - 10 reps @30X0 Tempo - Easy
Working Set 1 - 8 reps @30X0 Tempo - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 8 reps @30X0 Tempo - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - 8 reps @30X0 Tempo - RPE 9
RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

D) Strength Intensity 2 (15 min):
Wide Grip Bent Over Barbell Row

4 Working Sets; rest 2-3 min
Warm-Up Set - 10 reps @20X0 Tempo - Easy
Working Set 1 - 15 reps @20X0 Tempo - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 12 reps @20X0 Tempo - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - 10 reps @20X0 Tempo - RPE 9
Working Set 4 - Max Unbroken reps @20X0 Tempo - RPE 10 - Set 1 weight.
RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

E) Strength Balance (8 min):
Supinated Strict Pullup
Every 75 sec x 6 sets
Set 1: 6 reps @20X0 Tempo - RPE 7
Set 2: 6 reps @20X0 Tempo - RPE 7
Set 3: 6 reps @20X0 Tempo - RPE 8
Set 4: 6 reps @20X0 Tempo - RPE 8
Set 5: 6 reps @20X0 Tempo - RPE 9
Set 6: 6 reps @20X0 Tempo - RPE 9
RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.
Loading Note:
This is a high density format. Select assistance consistent with about a 12 rep max pullup. The format will remain the same for all odd weeks, aim to decrease assistance or improve quality throughout this training block.

F) Finisher (10 min):
2-3 sets
1. Cable Straight Arm Lat Pulldown or DB Pullover; 10-12 reps @30X0 Tempo
rest 30 sec
2. Hammer Curl; 10 reps @21X1 Tempo
rest 60 sec and back to 1.
Loading Note:
Perform 1 warmup set. Aim for each set to be close to form failure.

G) Cooldown (5 min):
1-2 sets
1. Cat Cow; 5 reps
1. Childs Pose Lat Stretch; 30 sec/side
1. Downdog to Updog; 5 reps with 2-3 sec hold in each position
1. Pigeon Stretch; 30-60 sec/side

Thursday, October 8th, 2026

Week 1 Day 4 - Persist PUMP LIFT 5x

A) Active Recovery Work (30 min):
Goal: Complete 30 minutes of low-intensity steady-state movement today. Go for a jog, hike, walk, ruck, bike, or swim. If you want a GYM OPTION, please use the following. You should keep your heart rate in the Zone 2 range. That can be calculated roughly as 65-75% of your theoretical maximal HR (220-age).
Run/Bike/Row 30 sec @75% effort
rest 30 sec
x 8 Sets
2-3 Sets
- Tall Plank Shoulder Taps x 20/side
- 30 sec Superman Hold
Run/Bike/Row 30 sec @75% effort
rest 30 sec
x 8 Sets
2-3 Sets
- Quadruped Plank Shoulder Taps x 20/side
- 30 sec Swimmer Kicks
Run/Bike/Row 30 sec @75% effort
rest 30 sec
x 8 Sets

B) PERSIST RECOVERY MOBILITY SESSION (30 min):
Front Splits
Supine Hamstring Stretch x 1 min/side
Active Straight Leg Raise x 5 reps/side with 5 sec hold
Couch Stretch x 1-2 min/side
Front Split Progression x 10 reps/side
Front Split x 1-2 min/side

Friday, October 9th, 2026

Week 1 Day 5 - Persist PUMP LIFT 5x

A) Daily Focus Notes:
Suitcase Rear Foot Elevated Split Squat

Putting the back foot up throws almost all the work onto the front leg. Holding the weight down at your sides instead of in front lets you load heavier without your upper back giving out first. Use straps if your grip fails before your legs do.
Short on time? Remove Finisher

B) Warmup (8 min):
2 min Cardio of Choice
3 Sets
1. 15 sec Cardio Sprint
1. Single Leg DB Glute Bridge; 10 reps/side
1. Deficit DB Sumo Deadlift; 10 reps

C) Strength Intensity (12 min):
Suitcase Rear Foot Elevated Split Squat
3 Working Sets; rest 2-3 min
Warm-Up Set - 10 reps/side @20X0 Tempo - Easy
Working Set 1 - 12 reps/side @20X0 Tempo - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 10 reps/side @20X0 Tempo - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - 8 reps/side @20X0 Tempo - RPE 9
RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

D) Strength Intensity 2 (15 min):
Landmine KOT Squat or Assisted KOT Squat
3 Working Sets; rest 2-3 min
Warm-Up Set 1 - 12 reps @30X0 Tempo - Easy
Warm-Up Set 2 - 10 reps @30X0 Tempo - Easy
Working Set 1 - 8-12 reps @30X0 Tempo - RPE 8
Working Set 2 - 8-12 reps @30X0 Tempo - RPE 9
Working Set 3 - 8-12 reps @30X0 Tempo - RPE 10
RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.
Effort Note:
You may adjust the tempo even more if needing to make this more challenging.

E) Strength Balance (10 min):
3 sets
1. Goblet Tall Kneel to Stand; 10 reps (5/side alternating)
directly into
1. Goblet Curtsy Squat; 10 reps (5/side alternating)
rest 90 sec and back to 1.

Loading Note:
Perform 1-2 warmup sets to determine starting weight. Aim for each set to be close to failure.

F) Finisher (10 min):
2-3 sets; rest as needed
30-40 Bicycle Crunch (15-20/side)
20-30 Heel Taps (10-15/side)
20-30 Russian Twist (10-15/side)
Effort Note:
Try to challenge yourself by keeping the rest minimum. If you are unsure start with 30-60 seconds rest between all movements and sets.

G) Cooldown (5 min):
1-2 sets
1. Seal Stretch; 30 sec
1. Pancake Stretch; 30 sec
1. Horse Stance Pulse; 30 sec

Saturday, October 10th, 2026

Week 1 Day 6 - Persist PUMP LIFT 5x

A) Daily Focus Notes:
Barbell Z Press
Sitting on the floor with your legs straight takes away every bit of help from your legs and lower back. Whatever you press here is honest overhead strength. If you find yourself leaning back to get the bar up, drop the weight.
Short on time? Remove Finisher

B) Warmup (8 min):
2 min Cardio of Choice
3 Sets
1. Prone Behind the Neck Press; 6-8 reps
1. Ring Y Row; 6-8 reps

C) Strength Intensity (12 min):
Barbell Z Press
4 Working Sets; rest 2 min
Warm-Up Set - 10 reps @20X1 Tempo - Easy
Working Set 1 - 8 reps @20X1 Tempo - RPE 7

Working Set 2 - 8 reps @20X1 Tempo - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - 8 reps @20X1 Tempo - RPE 9
Working Set 4 - Max Unbroken reps @20X1 Tempo - RPE 10 - Set 1 weight.
RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

D) Strength Intensity 2 (10 min):
Back Supported DB Arnold Press
3 Working Sets; rest 2 min between sets
Warm-Up Set - 10 reps @21X1 Tempo - Easy
Working Set 1 - 10 reps @21X1 Tempo - RPE 8
Working Set 2 - 10 reps @21X1 Tempo - RPE 9
Working Set 3 - Max Unbroken reps @21X1 Tempo - RPE 10 - Set 1 weight.
RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

E) Strength Balance (10 min):
3 sets
1. Inchworm Pushup; 6-8 reps
rest 30 sec
2. Dumbbell Front Raise; 10-12 reps @30X0 Tempo
rest 90 sec and back to 1.
Loading Note:
Perform 1-2 warmup sets to determine starting weight. Aim for each set to be close to failure.

F) Finisher (8 min):
2 sets
Dual Dumbbell Curl
"Dumbbell Curl Run the Rack"
rest 90-120 sec between sets
Loading Note:
For this finisher, you will start at a weight that you can perform about 10 dual dumbbell curls with. Perform a set to failure with that weight. Then decrease the weight and perform another set to failure, decrease weight again, and perform another set to failure. Continue in this order until you have done a total of 5 sets to failure. Once you have completed your 5th set to failure, rest 90-120 sec and then repeat one more time.

G) Cooldown (5 min):
1-2 sets
1. Theraband Around the World; 6-10 reps
1. Supinated Passive Hang; 30 sec

1. PVC Shoulder Extension Stretch; 30-60 sec

Sunday, October 11th, 2026

Week 1 Day 7 - Persist PUMP LIFT 5x

Over the next six weeks I want to cover some of the smaller, less obvious things that quietly get in the way of progress. We're starting with effort calibration.

Not every session is meant to be a max effort. That's actually by design.

If you're following a program with RPE guidelines, those numbers are there for a reason. An RPE 6 day isn't a waste of time, it's building the aerobic base and movement quality that makes your harder days more effective. The problem is most people either ignore the easy days and go too hard, or they treat every session like a casual workout and never actually push when it counts.

An RPE 8 should feel hard. Not destroyed, but genuinely challenging. If you're hitting your sets and feel like you had a lot more in the tank, you probably left results on the table. Learning to calibrate your effort, to hold back when the program asks you to and actually push when it counts, is one of the most underrated skills in training.

Warmly,
Marcus

Pump Lift 4x

Monday, October 5th, 2026

Week 1 Day 1 - Persist PUMP LIFT 4x

A) Daily Focus Notes:
Back Squat
Three seconds in the bottom is longer than it sounds. You cannot bounce out of a position you have been sitting in, so the pause shows whether your bottom is somewhere you can hold or just somewhere you pass through. Keep your air in and your back tight for the whole count, because once the brace goes the bar settles into you and standing up gets much harder.
Short on time? Remove Finisher

B) Warmup (8 min):
3 Rounds
1. 90 sec Cardio of Choice
1. Goblet Heel Sits; 10 reps
1. Ring Assisted Cossack Squat; 6 reps/side

C) Strength Intensity 1 (15 min):
Back Squat
3 Working Sets; rest 2-3 min
Warm-Up Set - 5 reps @33X1 Tempo - Easy
Warm-Up Set - 5 reps @33X1 Tempo - Easy
Working Set 1 - 5 reps @33X1 Tempo - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 5 reps @33X1 Tempo - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - 5 reps @33X1 Tempo - RPE 9
RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

D) Strength Intensity 2 (12-15 min):
Back Rack Reverse Lunge
3 Working Sets; rest 75-90 sec between all sides and sets
Warm-Up Set - 10 reps/side @20X0 Tempo - Easy
Working Set 1 - 10 reps/side @20X0 Tempo - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 10 reps/side @20X0 Tempo - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - 10 reps/side @20X0 Tempo - RPE 9
RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

E) Strength Balance (12 min):
3 sets
1. Assisted Nordic Hamstring Curl or BC Gliding Hamstring Curl; 8 reps @30X0 Tempo
rest 60 sec
2. Russian KB Swing; 10-15 reps
rest 60-90 sec and back to 1.
Loading Note:
Perform 1-2 warmup sets to determine starting weight. Aim for each set to be close to failure.

F) Finisher (10 min):
2-3 sets
1. Hollow Body Hold; 30 sec
rest 30 sec

2. Toes Elevated Donkey Calf Raise; 10-20 reps @20X0 Tempo
rest 60 sec and back to 1.
Loading Note:
Perform 1 warmup set. Aim for each set to be close to form failure.

G) Cooldown (5 min):
1-2 sets
1. Foot Elevated Hamstring Stretch; 30 sec/side
1. Dynamic Couch Stretch; 30 sec/side
1. Hip Sleeper Stretch; 30 sec/side

Tuesday, October 6th, 2026

Week 1 Day 2 - Persist PUMP LIFT 4x

A) Daily Focus Notes:
Close Grip Bench Press
Bringing your hands in shifts the work from the chest to the triceps and keeps your elbows tucked closer to your ribs. Expect to use less weight than your normal bench, that is the point. The last set is max reps at your first working weight, so leave something in the tank for it.
Short on time? Remove Finisher

B) Warmup (8 min):
2 min Cardio of Choice
3 Sets
1. 15 sec Cardio Sprint
1. Plank to Alternating Toe Touch; 6 reps/side
1. Half Kneeling Cable or Band Row; 10 reps/side

C) Strength Intensity 1 (15 min):
Close Grip Bench Press
4 Working Sets; rest 2 min
Warm-Up Set - 10 reps @20X1 Tempo - Easy
Working Set 1 - 8 reps @20X1 Tempo - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 8 reps @20X1 Tempo - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - 8 reps @20X1 Tempo - RPE 9
Working Set 4 - Max Unbroken reps @20X1 Tempo - RPE 10 - Set 1 weight.
RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

D) Strength Intensity 2 (15 min):

Wide Grip Bent Over Barbell Row
4 Working Sets; rest 2-3 min
Warm-Up Set - 10 reps @20X0 Tempo - Easy
Working Set 1 - 15 reps @20X0 Tempo - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 12 reps @20X0 Tempo - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - 10 reps @20X0 Tempo - RPE 9
Working Set 4 - Max Unbroken reps @20X0 Tempo - RPE 10 - Set 1 weight.
RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

E) Strength Balance (12 min):
3 sets
1. Incline Dumbbell Bench Press; 10 reps @30X0 Tempo
rest 60 sec
2. Barbell Skullcrushers; 12 reps @30X0 Tempo
rest 90 sec and back to 1.
Loading Note:
Perform 1-2 warmup sets to determine starting weight. Aim for each set to be close to failure.

F) Finisher (8 min):
2-3 sets
1. 1 1/4 Pushup; 6-10 reps @20X0 Tempo
rest 30 sec
2. Head Support DB Rear Delt Fly; 12-15 reps @30X0 Tempo
rest 60 sec and back to 1.
Loading Note:
Perform 1 warmup set. Aim for each set to be close to form failure.

G) Cooldown (5 min):
1-2 sets
1. Scorpion Chest Stretch; 30 sec/side
1. Banded Single Arm Behind the Back Stretch; 30 sec/side
1. Passive Hang; 30 sec

Wednesday, October 7th, 2026

Week 1 Day 3 - Persist PUMP LIFT 4x

A) Active Recovery Work (Optional):
Goal: Complete 30 minutes of low-intensity steady-state movement today. You can get out for a 30-minute walk, hike on some moderate terrain, or if you like to bike or swim, have at it.

B) PERSIST RECOVERY MOBILITY SESSION (10 min):
Overhead
Sidelying Thoracic Rotation x 5 reps/side with 2-3 sec hold
T Spine Can Opener x 1-2 min
Prayer Stretch x 1-2 min
Prone Swimmer x 5 reps with 5 sec hold in the overhead position

Thursday, October 8th, 2026

Week 1 Day 4 - Persist PUMP LIFT 4x

A) Daily Focus Notes:
Suitcase Rear Foot Elevated Split Squat
Putting the back foot up throws almost all the work onto the front leg. Holding the weight down at your sides instead of in front lets you load heavier without your upper back giving out first. Use straps if your grip fails before your legs do.
Short on time? Remove Finisher

B) Warmup (8 min):
2 min Cardio of Choice
3 Sets
1. 15 sec Cardio Sprint
1. Single Leg DB Glute Bridge; 10 reps/side
1. Deficit DB Sumo Deadlift; 10 reps

C) Strength Intensity 1 (12 min):
Suitcase Rear Foot Elevated Split Squat
3 Working Sets; rest 2-3 min
Warm-Up Set - 10 reps/side @20X0 Tempo - Easy
Working Set 1 - 12 reps/side @20X0 Tempo - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 10 reps/side @20X0 Tempo - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - 8 reps/side @20X0 Tempo - RPE 9
RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

D) Strength Intensity 2 (12 min):
Romanian Deadlift
3 Working Sets; rest 2-3 min
Warm-Up Set - 10 reps @30X0 Tempo - Easy
Working Set 1 - 8 reps @30X0 Tempo - RPE 7

Working Set 2 - 8 reps @30X0 Tempo - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - 8 reps @30X0 Tempo - RPE 9
RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

E) Strength Balance (12 min):
3 sets
1. Goblet Tall Kneel to Stand; 10 reps (5/side alternating)
directly into
1. Goblet Curtsy Squat; 10 reps (5/side alternating)
rest 90 sec and back to 1.
Loading Note:
Perform 1-2 warmup sets to determine starting weight. Aim for each set to be close to failure.

F) Finisher (10 min):
2-3 sets; rest as needed
30-40 Bicycle Crunch (15-20/side)
20-30 Heel Taps (10-15/side)
20-30 Russian Twist (10-15/side)
Effort Note:
Try to challenge yourself by keeping the rest minimum. If you are unsure start with 30-60 seconds rest between all movements and sets.

G) Cooldown (5 min):
1-2 sets
1. Seal Stretch; 30 sec
1. Pancake Stretch; 30 sec
1. Horse Stance Pulse; 30 sec

Friday, October 9th, 2026

Week 1 Day 5 - Persist PUMP LIFT 4x

A) Daily Focus Notes:
Barbell Z Press
Sitting on the floor with your legs straight takes away every bit of help from your legs and lower back. Whatever you press here is honest overhead strength. If you find yourself leaning back to get the bar up, drop the weight.
Short on time? Remove Finisher

B) Warmup (8 min):

2 min Cardio of Choice
3 Sets
1. Prone BTN Press; 6-8 reps
1. Ring Y Row; 6-8 reps

C) Strength Intensity 1 (12 min):
Barbell Z Press
4 Working Sets; rest 2 min
Warm-Up Set - 10 reps @20X1 Tempo - Easy
Working Set 1 - 8 reps @20X1 Tempo - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 8 reps @20X1 Tempo - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - 8 reps @20X1 Tempo - RPE 9
Working Set 4 - Max Unbroken reps @20X1 Tempo - RPE 10 - Set 1 weight.
RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

D) Strength Intensity 2 (8 min):
Supinated Strict Pullup
Every 75 sec x 6 sets
Set 1: 6 reps @20X0 Tempo - RPE 7
Set 2: 6 reps @20X0 Tempo - RPE 7
Set 3: 6 reps @20X0 Tempo - RPE 8
Set 4: 6 reps @20X0 Tempo - RPE 8
Set 5: 6 reps @20X0 Tempo - RPE 9
Set 6: 6 reps @20X0 Tempo - RPE 9
RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.
Loading Note:
This is a high density format. Select assistance consistent with about a 12 rep max pullup. The format will remain the same for all odd weeks, aim to decrease assistance or improve quality throughout this training block.

E) Strength Balance (10 min):
3 sets
1. Inchworm Pushup; 6-8 reps
rest 30 sec
2. DB Front Raise; 10-12 reps @30X0 Tempo
rest 90 sec and back to 1.
Loading Note:
Perform 1-2 warmup sets to determine starting weight. Aim for each set to be close to failure.

F) Finisher (8 min):
2 sets
Dual Dumbbell Curl
"Dumbbell Curl Run the Rack"
rest 90-120 sec between sets
Loading Note:
For this finisher, you will start at a weight that you can perform about 10 dual dumbbell curls with. Perform a set to failure with that weight. Then decrease the weight and perform another set to failure, decrease weight again, and perform another set to failure. Continue in this order until you have done a total of 5 sets to failure. Once you have completed your 5th set to failure, rest 90-120 sec and then repeat one more time.

G) Cooldown (5 min):
1-2 sets
1. Theraband Around the World; 6-10 reps
1. Supinated Passive Hang; 30 sec
1. PVC Shoulder Extension Stretch; 30-60 sec

Saturday, October 10th, 2026

Week 1 Day 6 - Persist PUMP LIFT 4x

A) Active Recovery Work (30 min):
Goal: Complete 30 minutes of low-intensity steady-state movement today. Go for a jog, hike, walk, ruck, bike, or swim. If you want a GYM OPTION, please use the following. You should keep your heart rate in the Zone 2 range. That can be calculated roughly as 65-75% of your theoretical maximal HR (220-age).
Run/Bike/Row 30 sec @75% effort
rest 30 sec
x 8 Sets
2-3 Sets
Tall Plank Shoulder Taps x 20/side
30 sec Superman Hold
Run/Bike/Row 30 sec @75% effort
rest 30 sec
x 8 Sets
2-3 Sets
Quadruped Plank Shoulder Taps x 20/side
30 sec Swimmer Kicks
Run/Bike/Row 30 sec @75% effort

rest 30 sec
x 8 Sets

B) PERSIST RECOVERY MOBILITY SESSION (10 min):
Front Splits
Supine Hamstring Stretch x 1 min/side
Active Straight Leg Raise x 5 reps/side with 5 sec hold
Couch Stretch x 1-2 min/side
Front Split Progression x 10 reps/side
Front Split x 1-2 min/side

Sunday, October 11th, 2026

Week 1 Day 7 - Persist PUMP LIFT 4x

Over the next six weeks I want to cover some of the smaller, less obvious things that quietly get in the way of progress. We're starting with effort calibration.

Not every session is meant to be a max effort. That's actually by design.

If you're following a program with RPE guidelines, those numbers are there for a reason. An RPE 6 day isn't a waste of time, it's building the aerobic base and movement quality that makes your harder days more effective. The problem is most people either ignore the easy days and go too hard, or they treat every session like a casual workout and never actually push when it counts.

An RPE 8 should feel hard. Not destroyed, but genuinely challenging. If you're hitting your sets and feel like you had a lot more in the tank, you probably left results on the table. Learning to calibrate your effort, to hold back when the program asks you to and actually push when it counts, is one of the most underrated skills in training.

Warmly,
Marcus

Pump Lift 3x

Monday, October 5th, 2026

Week 1 Day 1 - Persist PUMP LIFT 3x

A) Daily Focus Notes:
Back Squat
Three seconds in the bottom is longer than it sounds. You cannot bounce out of a position you have been sitting in, so the pause shows whether your bottom is somewhere you can hold or just somewhere you pass through. Keep your air in and your back tight for the whole count, because once the brace goes the bar settles into you and standing up gets much harder.
Short on time? Remove Finisher

B) Warmup (8 min):
3 Rounds
1. 90 sec Cardio of Choice
1. Goblet Heel Sits; 10 reps
1. Ring Assisted Cossack Squat; 6 reps/side
1. Band Pull Apart; 15-20 reps

C) Strength Intensity 1 (15 min):
Back Squat
3 Working Sets; rest 2-3 min
Warm-Up Set - 5 reps @33X1 Tempo - Easy
Warm-Up Set - 5 reps @33X1 Tempo - Easy
Working Set 1 - 5 reps @33X1 Tempo - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 5 reps @33X1 Tempo - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - 5 reps @33X1 Tempo - RPE 9
RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

D) Strength Intensity 2 (15 min):
Wide Grip Bent Over Barbell Row
4 Working Sets; rest 2-3 min
Warm-Up Set - 10 reps @20X0 Tempo - Easy
Working Set 1 - 15 reps @20X0 Tempo - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 12 reps @20X0 Tempo - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - 10 reps @20X0 Tempo - RPE 9
Working Set 4 - Max Unbroken reps @20X0 Tempo - RPE 10 - Set 1 weight.

RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

E) Strength Balance (12 min):
3 sets
1. Incline Dumbbell Bench Press; 10 reps @30X0 Tempo
rest 60 sec
2. Barbell Skullcrushers; 12 reps @30X0 Tempo
rest 90 sec and back to 1.
Loading Note:
Perform 1-2 warmup sets to determine starting weight. Aim for each set to be close to failure.

F) Finisher (8 min):
2 sets
Dual Dumbbell Curl
"Dumbbell Curl Run the Rack"
rest 90-120 sec between sets
Loading Note:
For this finisher, you will start at a weight that you can perform about 10 dual dumbbell curls with. Perform a set to failure with that weight. Then decrease the weight and perform another set to failure, decrease weight again, and perform another set to failure. Continue in this order until you have done a total of 5 sets to failure. Once you have completed your 5th set to failure, rest 90-120 sec and then repeat one more time.

G) Cooldown (5 min):
1-2 sets
1. Foot Elevated Hamstring Stretch; 30 sec/side
1. Dynamic Couch Stretch; 30 sec/side
1. PVC Shoulder Extension Stretch; 30 sec

Tuesday, October 6th, 2026

Week 1 Day 2 - Persist PUMP LIFT 3x

A) Active Recovery Work (Optional):
Goal: Complete 30 minutes of low-intensity steady-state movement today. You can get out for a 30-minute walk, hike on some moderate terrain, or if you like to bike or swim, have at it.

B) PERSIST RECOVERY MOBILITY SESSION:
Overhead
Sidelying Thoracic Rotation x 5 reps/side with 2-3 sec hold

T Spine Can Opener x 1-2 min
Prayer Stretch x 1-2 min
Prone Swimmer x 5 reps with 5 sec hold in the overhead position

Wednesday, October 7th, 2026

Week 1 Day 3 - Persist PUMP LIFT 3x

A) Daily Focus Notes:
Romanian Deadlift
The reps stay the same across all three sets and only the effort climbs, so this is a week for setting your baseline rather than chasing a top set. Start lighter than feels necessary and build across the sets. Keep the bar brushing your legs the whole way down, because the moment it drifts forward your lower back takes over the work.
Short on time? Remove Finisher

B) Warmup (8 min):
2 min Cardio of Choice
3 Sets
1. Banded Goodmorning; 10-15 reps
1. Glute Bridge Alternating DB Floor Press; 6-8 reps/side

C) Strength Intensity 1 (12 min):
Romanian Deadlift
3 Working Sets; rest 2-3 min
Warm-Up Set - 10 reps @30X0 Tempo - Easy
Working Set 1 - 8 reps @30X0 Tempo - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 8 reps @30X0 Tempo - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - 8 reps @30X0 Tempo - RPE 9
RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

D) Strength Intensity 2 (15 min):
Close Grip Bench Press
4 Working Sets; rest 2 min
Warm-Up Set - 10 reps @20X1 Tempo - Easy
Working Set 1 - 8 reps @20X1 Tempo - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 8 reps @20X1 Tempo - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - 8 reps @20X1 Tempo - RPE 9
Working Set 4 - Max Unbroken reps @20X1 Tempo - RPE 10 - Set 1 weight.
RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

E) Strength Balance (10 min):
3 sets
1. Inchworm Pushup; 6-8 reps
rest 30 sec
2. DB Front Raise; 10-12 reps @30X0 Tempo
rest 90 sec and back to 1.
Loading Note:
Perform 1-2 warmup sets to determine starting weight. Aim for each set to be close to failure.

F) Finisher (10 min):
2-3 sets
1. Hollow Body Hold; 30 sec
rest 30 sec
2. Toes Elevated Donkey Calf Raise; 10-20 reps @20X0 Tempo
rest 60 sec and back to 1.
Loading Note:
Perform 1 warmup set. Aim for each set to be close to form failure.

G) Cooldown (5 min):
1-2 sets
1. Scorpion Chest Stretch; 30 sec/side
1. Hip Sleeper Stretch; 30 sec/side
1. Passive Hang; 30 sec

Thursday, October 8th, 2026

Week 1 Day 4 - Persist PUMP LIFT 3x

A) Active Recovery Work (30 min):
Goal: Complete 30 minutes of low-intensity steady-state movement today. You can get out for a 30-minute walk, hike on some moderate terrain, or if you like to bike or swim, have at it.

B) PERSIST RECOVERY MOBILITY SESSION (10 min):
Front Splits
Supine Hamstring Stretch x 1 min/side
Active Straight Leg Raise x 5 reps/side with 5 sec hold
Couch Stretch x 1-2 min/side
Front Split Progression x 10 reps/side
Front Split x 1-2 min/side

Friday, October 9th, 2026

Week 1 Day 5 - Persist PUMP LIFT 3x

A) Daily Focus Notes:
Barbell Z Press
Sitting on the floor with your legs straight takes away every bit of help from your legs and lower back. Whatever you press here is honest overhead strength. If you find yourself leaning back to get the bar up, drop the weight.
Short on time? Remove Finisher

B) Warmup (10 min):
2 min Cardio of Choice
3 Sets
1. Band Pull Apart; 15-20 reps
1. Ring Y Row; 6-8 reps
1. Lateral Banded Walk; 10m/side

C) Strength Intensity 1 (12 min):
Barbell Z Press
4 Working Sets; rest 2 min
Warm-Up Set - 10 reps @20X1 Tempo - Easy
Working Set 1 - 8 reps @20X1 Tempo - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 8 reps @20X1 Tempo - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - 8 reps @20X1 Tempo - RPE 9
Working Set 4 - Max Unbroken reps @20X1 Tempo - RPE 10 - Set 1 weight.
RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

D) Strength Intensity 2 (8 min):
Supinated Strict Pullup
Every 75 sec x 6 sets
Set 1: 6 reps @20X0 Tempo - RPE 7
Set 2: 6 reps @20X0 Tempo - RPE 7
Set 3: 6 reps @20X0 Tempo - RPE 8
Set 4: 6 reps @20X0 Tempo - RPE 8
Set 5: 6 reps @20X0 Tempo - RPE 9
Set 6: 6 reps @20X0 Tempo - RPE 9
RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.
Loading Note:

This is a high density format. Select assistance consistent with about a 12 rep max pullup. The format will remain the same for all odd weeks, aim to decrease assistance or improve quality throughout this training block.

E) Strength Balance (12 min):
3 sets
1. Suitcase Rear Foot Elevated Split Squat; 10 reps/side @20X0 Tempo
rest 60 sec
2. Russian KB Swing; 10-15 reps
rest 60-90 sec and back to 1.
Loading Note:
Perform 1-2 warmup sets to determine starting weight. Aim for each set to be close to failure.

F) Finisher (10 min):
2-3 sets; rest as needed
30-40 Bicycle Crunch (15-20/side)
20-30 Heel Taps (10-15/side)
20-30 Russian Twist (10-15/side)
Effort Note:
Try to challenge yourself by keeping the rest minimum. If you are unsure start with 30-60 seconds rest between all movements and sets.

G) Cooldown (5 min):
1-2 sets
1. Seal Stretch; 30 sec
1. Pancake Stretch; 30 sec
1. Theraband Around the World; 10 reps

Saturday, October 10th, 2026

Week 1 Day 6 - Persist PUMP LIFT 3x

A) Active Recovery Work (30 min):
Goal: Complete 30 minutes of low-intensity steady-state movement today. Go for a jog, hike, walk, ruck, bike, or swim. If you want a GYM OPTION, please use the following. You should keep your heart rate in the Zone 2 range. That can be calculated roughly as 65-75% of your theoretical maximal HR (220-age).
Run/Bike/Row 30 sec @75% effort
rest 30 sec
x 8 Sets

2-3 Sets
Tall Plank Shoulder Taps x 20/side
30 sec Superman Hold
Run/Bike/Row 30 sec @75% effort
rest 30 sec
x 8 Sets
2-3 Sets
Quadruped Plank Shoulder Taps x 20/side
30 sec Swimmer Kicks
Run/Bike/Row 30 sec @75% effort
rest 30 sec
x 8 Sets

B) PERSIST RECOVERY MOBILITY SESSION (10 min):
Middle Splits
Half Split Hip Hinge x 5-7 reps/side
Weighted Butterfly Stretch x 2 min
Middle Split x 2 min
Middle Split Hip Hinge x 10 reps
Middle Split Knee Bends x 10 reps
Bottom of Squat Hold x 1-2 min

Sunday, October 11th, 2026

Week 1 Day 7 - Persist PUMP LIFT 3x

Over the next six weeks I want to cover some of the smaller, less obvious things that quietly get in the way of progress. We're starting with effort calibration.

Not every session is meant to be a max effort. That's actually by design.

If you're following a program with RPE guidelines, those numbers are there for a reason. An RPE 6 day isn't a waste of time, it's building the aerobic base and movement quality that makes your harder days more effective. The problem is most people either ignore the easy days and go too hard, or they treat every session like a casual workout and never actually push when it counts.

An RPE 8 should feel hard. Not destroyed, but genuinely challenging. If you're hitting your sets and feel like you had a lot more in the tank, you probably left results on the table. Learning to calibrate

your effort, to hold back when the program asks you to and actually push when it counts, is one of the most underrated skills in training.

Warmly,
Marcus

Pump Condition 5x

Monday, October 5th, 2026

Week 1 Day 1 - Persist PUMP CONDITION 5x

A) Daily Focus Notes:
Back Squat
Three seconds in the bottom is longer than it sounds. You cannot bounce out of a position you have been sitting in, so the pause shows whether your bottom is somewhere you can hold or just somewhere you pass through. Keep your air in and your back tight for the whole count, because once the brace goes the bar settles into you and standing up gets much harder.
Short on time? Remove Strength Balance or Aerobic Lower Body based on your goals.

B) Warmup (8 min):
3 Rounds
1. 90 sec Cardio of Choice
1. Goblet Heel Sits; 10 reps
1. Ring Assisted Cossack Squat; 6 reps/side

C) Strength Intensity 1 (15 min):
Back Squat
3 Working Sets; rest 2-3 min
Warm-Up Set - 5 reps @33X1 Tempo - Easy
Warm-Up Set - 5 reps @33X1 Tempo - Easy
Working Set 1 - 5 reps @33X1 Tempo - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 5 reps @33X1 Tempo - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - 5 reps @33X1 Tempo - RPE 9
RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

D) Strength Balance (10 min):

3 sets
1. Assisted Nordic Hamstring Curl or BC Gliding Hamstring Curl; 8 reps @30X0 Tempo
rest 60 sec
2. Russian KB Swing; 10-15 reps
rest 60-90 sec and back to 1.
Loading Note:
Perform 1-2 warmup sets to determine starting weight. Aim for each set to be close to failure.

E) Aerobic Lower Body (15 min):
15 min Continuous Effort
Row 60 sec @ 60% effort
Row 30 sec @ 85% effort
20 Dumbbell Suitcase Walking Lunge (50/35) (Male/Female)
20 Tall Plank Knee to Elbow (10/side)
Effort Note:
Perform at a sustainable pace. You may break up the weighted movements as needed to keep quality high. Make sure that you can sustain a good pace on the Row each round.

F) Cooldown (5 min):
1-2 sets
1. Foot Elevated Hamstring Stretch; 30 sec/side
1. Dynamic Couch Stretch; 30 sec/side
1. Hip Sleeper Stretch; 30 sec/side

Tuesday, October 6th, 2026

Week 1 Day 2 - Persist PUMP CONDITION 5x

A) Daily Focus Notes:
Close Grip Bench Press
Bringing your hands in shifts the work from the chest to the triceps and keeps your elbows tucked closer to your ribs. Expect to use less weight than your normal bench, that is the point. The last set is max reps at your first working weight, so leave something in the tank for it.
Short on time? Remove Strength Balance or Press Core Conditioning based on your goals.

B) Warmup (8 min):
2 min Cardio of Choice
3 Sets
1. 15 sec Cardio Sprint
1. Plank to Alternating Toe Touch; 6 reps/side

1. Half Kneeling Cable or Band Row; 10 reps/side

C) Strength Intensity 1 (12 min):
Close Grip Bench Press
4 Working Sets; rest 2 min
Warm-Up Set - 10 reps @20X1 Tempo - Easy
Working Set 1 - 8 reps @20X1 Tempo - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 8 reps @20X1 Tempo - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - 8 reps @20X1 Tempo - RPE 9
Working Set 4 - Max Unbroken reps @20X1 Tempo - RPE 10 - Set 1 weight.
RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

D) Strength Balance (10 min):
3 sets
1. Incline Dumbbell Chest Fly; 10 reps @30X0 Tempo
rest 30 sec
2. Barbell Skullcrushers; 10 reps @30X0 Tempo
rest 90 sec and back to 1.
Loading Note:
Perform 1-2 warmup sets to determine starting weight. Aim for each set to be close to failure.

E) Press Core Conditioning (15 min):
For Time
8-10-12-10-8
Toes to Bar or Hanging Knee Tucks
Dumbbell Bench Press @30X0 Tempo
*At the end of each round, complete 10 Burpees
*15 min CAP
Effort Note:
Perform this at a consistent pace. Select a weight that you could perform for 15 reps @RPE 8-9.

F) Cooldown (5 min):
1-2 sets
1. Scorpion Chest Stretch; 30 sec/side
1. Banded Single Arm Behind the Back Stretch; 30 sec/side
1. Passive Hang; 30 sec

Wednesday, October 7th, 2026

Week 1 Day 3 - Persist PUMP CONDITION 5x

A) Daily Focus Notes:
Romanian Deadlift
The RDL is a hinge, not a squat. Push your hips back, keep the bar dragging close to your legs, and stop when you feel the stretch behind your knees. Three seconds down on every rep is what builds the hamstrings here, so do not rush the lowering.
Short on time? Remove Strength Balance or Increasing Effort based on your goals.

B) Warmup (8 min):
2 min Cardio of Choice
3 Sets
1. Banded Goodmorning; 10-15 reps
1. Dumbbell Chainsaw Row; 6-8 reps/side

C) Strength Intensity 1 (12 min):
Romanian Deadlift
3 Working Sets; rest 2-3 min
Warm-Up Set - 10 reps @30X0 Tempo - Easy
Working Set 1 - 8 reps @30X0 Tempo - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 8 reps @30X0 Tempo - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - 8 reps @30X0 Tempo - RPE 9
RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

D) Strength Balance (8 min):
Supinated Strict Pullup
Every 75 sec x 6 sets
Set 1: 6 reps @20X0 Tempo - RPE 7
Set 2: 6 reps @20X0 Tempo - RPE 7
Set 3: 6 reps @20X0 Tempo - RPE 8
Set 4: 6 reps @20X0 Tempo - RPE 8
Set 5: 6 reps @20X0 Tempo - RPE 9
Set 6: 6 reps @20X0 Tempo - RPE 9
RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.
Loading Note:
This is a high density format. Select assistance consistent with about a 12 rep max pullup. The format will remain the same for all odd weeks, aim to decrease assistance or improve quality throughout this training block.

E) Increasing Effort (15 min):

3 sets
10 Barbell Bent Over Row
rest 15 sec
30 sec Hollow Body Hold
rest 15 sec
15 Russian KB Swing (70/53) (Male/Female)
rest 15 sec
Row 60 sec (must increase the effort of each row)
rest 90 sec
Effort Note:
Increasing Row pace per set. Select a weight for the bent over row that will elicit a hypertrophy stimulus.

F) Cooldown (5 min):
1-2 sets
1. Cat Cow; 5 reps
1. Childs Pose Lat Stretch; 30 sec/side
1. Downdog to Updog; 5 reps with 2-3 sec hold in each position
1. Pigeon Stretch; 30-60 sec/side

Thursday, October 8th, 2026

Week 1 Day 4 - Persist PUMP CONDITION 5x

A) Active Recovery Work (30 min):
Goal: Complete 30 minutes of low-intensity steady-state movement today. Go for a jog, hike, walk, ruck, bike, or swim. If you want a GYM OPTION, please use the following. You should keep your heart rate in the Zone 2 range. That can be calculated roughly as 65-75% of your theoretical maximal HR (220-age).
Run/Bike/Row 30 sec @75% effort
rest 30 sec
x 8 Sets
2-3 Sets
- Tall Plank Shoulder Taps x 20/side
- 30 sec Superman Hold
Run/Bike/Row 30 sec @75% effort
rest 30 sec
x 8 Sets
2-3 Sets
- Quadruped Plank Shoulder Taps x 20/side

- 30 sec Swimmer Kicks
Run/Bike/Row 30 sec @75% effort
rest 30 sec
x 8 Sets

B) PERSIST RECOVERY MOBILITY SESSION (10 min):
Front Splits
Supine Hamstring Stretch x 1 min/side
Active Straight Leg Raise x 5 reps/side with 5 sec hold
Couch Stretch x 1-2 min/side
Front Split Progression x 10 reps/side
Front Split x 1-2 min/side

Friday, October 9th, 2026

Week 1 Day 5 - Persist PUMP CONDITION 5x

A) Daily Focus Notes:
Suitcase Rear Foot Elevated Split Squat
Putting the back foot up throws almost all the work onto the front leg. Holding the weight down at your sides instead of in front lets you load heavier without your upper back giving out first. Use straps if your grip fails before your legs do.
Short on time? Remove Strength Balance or Anaerobic Power Conditioning based on your goals.

B) Warmup (8 min):
2 min Cardio of Choice
3 Sets
1. 15 sec Cardio Sprint
1. Single Leg Dumbbell Glute Bridge; 10 reps/side
1. Deficit Dumbbell Sumo Deadlift; 10 reps

C) Strength Intensity 1 (15 min):
Suitcase Rear Foot Elevated Split Squat
3 Working Sets; rest 2-3 min
Warm-Up Set - 10 reps/side @20X0 Tempo - Easy
Working Set 1 - 12 reps/side @20X0 Tempo - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 10 reps/side @20X0 Tempo - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - 8 reps/side @20X0 Tempo - RPE 9
RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

D) Strength Balance (10 min):
3 sets
1. Goblet Tall Kneel to Stand; 10 reps (5/side alternating)
directly into
1. Goblet Curtsy Squat; 10 reps (5/side alternating)
rest 90 sec and back to 1.
Loading Note:
Perform 1-2 warmup sets to determine starting weight. Aim for each set to be close to failure.

E) Anaerobic Power Conditioning (15 min):
4-6 sets
Box Jump Step Down; 10 reps
rest 10 sec
Row 15 sec @ 97% effort
rest walk 1:30-2:00
Effort Note:
The goal is maximal output, do NOT pace. The set range is meant to be adapted based on your physiology. If you are more powerful you will likely perform fewer sets (because the intensity of each set is higher). If you are more endurant, you may need more sets to achieve the desired stimulus (because the intensity of each set is lower).

F) Cooldown (5 min):
1-2 sets
1. Seal Stretch; 30 sec
1. Pancake Stretch; 30 sec
1. Horse Stance Pulse; 30 sec

Saturday, October 10th, 2026

Week 1 Day 6 - Persist PUMP CONDITION 5x

A) Daily Focus Notes:
Barbell Z Press
Sitting on the floor with your legs straight takes away every bit of help from your legs and lower back. Whatever you press here is honest overhead strength. If you find yourself leaning back to get the bar up, drop the weight.
Short on time? Remove Strength Balance or Functional Pump Conditioning based on your goals.

B) Warmup (8 min):
2 min Cardio of Choice

3 Sets
1. Prone Behind the Neck Press; 6-8 reps
1. Ring Y Row; 6-8 reps

C) Strength Intensity 1 (15 min):
Barbell Z Press
4 Working Sets; rest 2 min
Warm-Up Set - 10 reps @20X1 Tempo - Easy
Working Set 1 - 8 reps @20X1 Tempo - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 8 reps @20X1 Tempo - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - 8 reps @20X1 Tempo - RPE 9
Working Set 4 - Max Unbroken reps @20X1 Tempo - RPE 10 - Set 1 weight.
RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

D) Strength Balance (10 min):
3 sets
1. Inchworm Pushup; 6-8 reps
rest 30 sec
2. Dumbbell Front Raise; 10-12 reps @30X0 Tempo
rest 90 sec and back to 1.
Loading Note:
Perform 1-2 warmup sets to determine starting weight. Aim for each set to be close to failure.

E) Functional Pump Conditioning (15 min):
12 min AMRAP @ sustainable effort
Bike 60 sec
10 Alternating Kettlebell Gorilla Row (5/side) (44/26) (Male/Female)
5 Strict Kettlebell Press (44/26)
5 Kettlebell Push Press (44/26)
20m Quadruped Crawl
Effort Note:
Perform a sustainable pace with consistent or very gradual increase in heart rate or breathing for all 12 minutes.

F) Cooldown (5 min):
1-2 sets
1. Theraband Around the World; 6-10 reps
1. Supinated Passive Hang; 30 sec
1. PVC Shoulder Extension Stretch; 30-60 sec

Sunday, October 11th, 2026

Week 1 Day 7 - Persist PUMP CONDITION 5x

Over the next six weeks I want to cover some of the smaller, less obvious things that quietly get in the way of progress. We're starting with effort calibration.

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An RPE 8 should feel hard. Not destroyed, but genuinely challenging. If you're hitting your sets and feel like you had a lot more in the tank, you probably left results on the table. Learning to calibrate your effort, to hold back when the program asks you to and actually push when it counts, is one of the most underrated skills in training.

Warmly,
Marcus

Pump Condition 4x

Monday, October 5th, 2026

Week 1 Day 1 - Persist PUMP CONDITION 4x

A) Daily Focus Notes:
Back Squat
Three seconds in the bottom is longer than it sounds. You cannot bounce out of a position you have been sitting in, so the pause shows whether your bottom is somewhere you can hold or just somewhere you pass through. Keep your air in and your back tight for the whole count, because once the brace goes the bar settles into you and standing up gets much harder.
Short on time? Remove Strength Balance or Aerobic Lower Body based on your goals.

B) Warmup (8 min):

3 Rounds
1. 90 sec Cardio of Choice
1. Goblet Heel Sits; 10 reps
1. Ring Assisted Cossack Squat; 6 reps/side

C) Strength Intensity (15 min):
Back Squat
3 Working Sets; rest 2-3 min
Warm-Up Set - 5 reps @33X1 Tempo - Easy
Warm-Up Set - 5 reps @33X1 Tempo - Easy
Working Set 1 - 5 reps @33X1 Tempo - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 5 reps @33X1 Tempo - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - 5 reps @33X1 Tempo - RPE 9
RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

D) Strength Balance (12 min):
3 sets
1. Assisted Nordic Hamstring Curl or BC Gliding Hamstring Curl; 8 reps @30X0 Tempo
rest 60 sec
2. Russian KB Swing; 10-15 reps
rest 60-90 sec and back to 1.
Loading Note: Perform 1-2 warmup sets to determine starting weight. Aim for each set to be close to failure.

E) Aerobic Lower Body (15 min):
15 min Continuous Effort
Row 60 sec @ 60% effort
Row 30 sec @ 85% effort
20 Dumbbell Suitcase Walking Lunge (10/side) (50/35) (Male/Female)
20 Tall Plank Knee to Elbow (10/side)
Effort Note: Perform at a sustainable pace. You may break up the weighted movements as needed to keep quality high. Make sure that you can sustain a good pace on the Row each round.

F) Cooldown (5 min):
1-2 sets
1. Foot Elevated Hamstring Stretch; 30 sec/side
1. Dynamic Couch Stretch; 30 sec/side
1. Hip Sleeper Stretch; 30 sec/side

Tuesday, October 6th, 2026

Week 1 Day 2 - Persist PUMP CONDITION 4x

A) Daily Focus Notes:
Close Grip Bench Press
Bringing your hands in shifts the work from the chest to the triceps and keeps your elbows tucked closer to your ribs. Expect to use less weight than your normal bench, that is the point. The last set is max reps at your first working weight, so leave something in the tank for it.
Short on time? Remove Strength Balance or Press Core Conditioning based on your goals.

B) Warmup (8 min):
2 min Cardio of Choice
3 Sets
1. 15 sec Cardio Sprint
1. Plank to Alternating Toe Touch; 6 reps/side
1. Half Kneeling Cable or Band Row; 10 reps/side

C) Strength Intensity (15 min):
Close Grip Bench Press
4 Working Sets; rest 2 min
Warm-Up Set - 10 reps @20X1 Tempo - Easy
Working Set 1 - 8 reps @20X1 Tempo - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 8 reps @20X1 Tempo - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - 8 reps @20X1 Tempo - RPE 9
Working Set 4 - Max Unbroken reps @20X1 Tempo - RPE 10 - Set 1 weight.
RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

D) Strength Balance (10 min):
3 sets
1. Incline Dumbbell Chest Fly; 10 reps @30X0 Tempo
rest 30 sec
2. Barbell Skullcrushers; 10 reps @30X0 Tempo
rest 90 sec and back to 1.
Loading Note: Perform 1-2 warmup sets to determine starting weight. Aim for each set to be close to failure.

E) Press Core Conditioning (15 min):
For Time
8-10-12-10-8

Toes to Bar or Hanging Knee Tucks
Dumbbell Bench Press @30X0 Tempo
*At the end of each round, complete 10 Burpees
*15 min CAP
Effort Note: Perform this at a consistent pace. Select a weight that you could perform for 15 reps @RPE 8-9.

F) Cooldown (5 min):
1-2 sets
1. Scorpion Chest Stretch; 30 sec/side
1. Banded Single Arm Behind the Back Stretch; 30 sec/side
1. Passive Hang; 30 sec

Wednesday, October 7th, 2026

Week 1 Day 3 - Persist PUMP CONDITION 4x

A) Active Recovery Work (30 min):
Goal: Complete 30 minutes of low-intensity steady-state movement today. You can get out for a 30-minute walk, hike on some moderate terrain, or if you like to bike or swim, have at it.

B) PERSIST RECOVERY MOBILITY SESSION (10 min):
Overhead
Sidelying Thoracic Rotation x 5 reps/side with 2-3 sec hold
T Spine Can Opener x 1-2 min
Prayer Stretch x 1-2 min
Prone Swimmer x 5 reps with 5 sec hold in the overhead position

Thursday, October 8th, 2026

Week 1 Day 4 - Persist PUMP CONDITION 4x

A) Daily Focus Notes:
Romanian Deadlift
The RDL is a hinge, not a squat. Push your hips back, keep the bar dragging close to your legs, and stop when you feel the stretch behind your knees. Three seconds down on every rep is what builds the hamstrings here, so do not rush the lowering.
Short on time? Remove Strength Balance or Anaerobic Power Conditioning based on your goals.

B) Warmup (8 min):

2 min Cardio of Choice
3 Sets
1. 15 sec Cardio Sprint
1. Single Leg Dumbbell Glute Bridge; 10 reps/side
1. Deficit Dumbbell Sumo Deadlift; 10 reps

C) Strength Intensity (12 min):
Romanian Deadlift
3 Working Sets; rest 2-3 min
Warm-Up Set - 10 reps @30X0 Tempo - Easy
Working Set 1 - 8 reps @30X0 Tempo - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 8 reps @30X0 Tempo - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - 8 reps @30X0 Tempo - RPE 9
RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

D) Strength Balance (12 min):
3 sets
1. Goblet Tall Kneel to Stand; 10 reps (5/side alternating)
directly into
1. Goblet Curtsy Squat; 10 reps (5/side alternating)
rest 90 sec and back to 1.
Loading Note: Perform 1-2 warmup sets to determine starting weight. Aim for each set to be close to failure.

E) Anaerobic Power Conditioning (15 min):
4-6 sets
Box Jump Step Down; 10 reps
rest 10 sec
Row 15 sec @ 97% effort
rest walk 1:30-2:00
Effort Note: The goal is maximal output, do NOT pace. The set range is meant to be adapted based on your physiology. If you are more powerful you will likely perform fewer sets (because the intensity of each set is higher). If you are more endurant, you may need more sets to achieve the desired stimulus (because the intensity of each set is lower).

F) Cooldown (5 min):
1-2 sets
1. Seal Stretch; 30 sec
1. Pancake Stretch; 30 sec

1. Horse Stance Pulse; 30 sec

Friday, October 9th, 2026

Week 1 Day 5 - Persist PUMP CONDITION 4x

A) Daily Focus Notes:
Barbell Z Press
Sitting on the floor with your legs straight takes away every bit of help from your legs and lower back. Whatever you press here is honest overhead strength. If you find yourself leaning back to get the bar up, drop the weight.
Short on time? Remove Strength Balance or Functional Pump Conditioning based on your goals.

B) Warmup (8 min):
2 min Cardio of Choice
3 Sets
1. Prone Behind the Neck Press; 6-8 reps
1. Ring Y Row; 6-8 reps

C) Strength Intensity (15 min):
Barbell Z Press
4 Working Sets; rest 2 min
Warm-Up Set - 10 reps @20X1 Tempo - Easy
Working Set 1 - 8 reps @20X1 Tempo - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 8 reps @20X1 Tempo - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - 8 reps @20X1 Tempo - RPE 9
Working Set 4 - Max Unbroken reps @20X1 Tempo - RPE 10 - Set 1 weight.
RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

D) Strength Balance (8 min):
Supinated Strict Pullup
Every 75 sec x 6 sets
Set 1: 6 reps @20X0 Tempo - RPE 7
Set 2: 6 reps @20X0 Tempo - RPE 7
Set 3: 6 reps @20X0 Tempo - RPE 8
Set 4: 6 reps @20X0 Tempo - RPE 8
Set 5: 6 reps @20X0 Tempo - RPE 9
Set 6: 6 reps @20X0 Tempo - RPE 9
RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

Loading Note: This is a high density format. Select assistance consistent with about a 12 rep max pullup. The format will remain the same for all odd weeks, aim to decrease assistance or improve quality throughout this training block.

E) Functional Pump Conditioning (15 min):
12 min AMRAP @ sustainable effort
Bike 60 sec
10 Alternating Kettlebell Gorilla Row (5/side) (44/26) (Male/Female)
10 Strict Kettlebell Press (44/26)
10 Kettlebell Push Press (44/26)
20m Quadruped Crawl
Effort Note: Perform a sustainable pace with consistent or very gradual increase in heart rate or breathing for all 12 minutes.

F) Cooldown (5 min):
1-2 sets
1. Theraband Around the World; 6-10 reps
1. Supinated Passive Hang; 30 sec
1. PVC Shoulder Extension Stretch; 30-60 sec

Saturday, October 10th, 2026

Week 1 Day 6 - Persist PUMP CONDITION 4x

A) Active Recovery Work (30 min):
Goal: Complete 30 minutes of low-intensity steady-state movement today. Go for a jog, hike, walk, ruck, bike, or swim. If you want a GYM OPTION, please use the following. You should keep your heart rate in the Zone 2 range. That can be calculated roughly as 65-75% of your theoretical maximal HR (220-age).
Run/Bike/Row 30 sec @75% effort
rest 30 sec
x 8 Sets
2-3 Sets
Tall Plank Shoulder Taps x 20/side
30 sec Superman Hold
Run/Bike/Row 30 sec @75% effort
rest 30 sec
x 8 Sets
2-3 Sets
Quadruped Plank Shoulder Taps x 20/side

30 sec Swimmer Kicks
Run/Bike/Row 30 sec @75% effort
rest 30 sec
x 8 Sets

B) PERSIST RECOVERY MOBILITY SESSION (10 min):
Front Splits
Supine Hamstring Stretch x 1 min/side
Active Straight Leg Raise x 5 reps/side with 5 sec hold
Couch Stretch x 1-2 min/side
Front Split Progression x 10 reps/side
Front Split x 1-2 min/side

Sunday, October 11th, 2026

Week 1 Day 7 - Persist PUMP CONDITION 4x

Over the next six weeks I want to cover some of the smaller, less obvious things that quietly get in the way of progress. We're starting with effort calibration.

Not every session is meant to be a max effort. That's actually by design.

If you're following a program with RPE guidelines, those numbers are there for a reason. An RPE 6 day isn't a waste of time, it's building the aerobic base and movement quality that makes your harder days more effective. The problem is most people either ignore the easy days and go too hard, or they treat every session like a casual workout and never actually push when it counts.

An RPE 8 should feel hard. Not destroyed, but genuinely challenging. If you're hitting your sets and feel like you had a lot more in the tank, you probably left results on the table. Learning to calibrate your effort, to hold back when the program asks you to and actually push when it counts, is one of the most underrated skills in training.

Warmly,
Marcus

Pump Condition 3x

Monday, October 5th, 2026

Week 1 Day 1 - Persist PUMP CONDITION 3x

A) Daily Focus Notes:
Back Squat
Three seconds in the bottom is longer than it sounds. You cannot bounce out of a position you have been sitting in, so the pause shows whether your bottom is somewhere you can hold or just somewhere you pass through. Keep your air in and your back tight for the whole count, because once the brace goes the bar settles into you and standing up gets much harder.
Short on time? Remove Strength Balance or Functional Pump Conditioning based on your goals.

B) Warmup (8 min):
3 Rounds
1. 90 sec Cardio of Choice
1. Goblet Heel Sits; 10 reps
1. Ring Assisted Cossack Squat; 6 reps/side

C) Strength Intensity 1 (15 min):
Back Squat
3 Working Sets; rest 2-3 min
Warm-Up Set - 5 reps @33X1 Tempo - Easy
Warm-Up Set - 5 reps @33X1 Tempo - Easy
Working Set 1 - 5 reps @33X1 Tempo - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 5 reps @33X1 Tempo - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - 5 reps @33X1 Tempo - RPE 9
RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

D) Strength Balance (12 min):
3 sets
1. Incline Dumbbell Bench Press; 10 reps @30X0 Tempo
rest 60 sec
2. Barbell Skullcrushers; 12 reps @30X0 Tempo
rest 90 sec and back to 1.
Loading Note: Perform 1-2 warmup sets to determine starting weight. Aim for each set to be close to failure.

E) Functional Pump Conditioning (12 min):
12 min AMRAP @ sustainable effort
Bike 60 sec
10 Alternating Kettlebell Gorilla Row (5/side) (44/26)
10 Strict Kettlebell Press (44/26)
10 Kettlebell Push Press (44/26)
20m Quadruped Crawl
Effort Note: Perform a sustainable pace with a consistent or very gradual increase in heart rate or breathing for all 12 minutes.

F) Cooldown (5 min):
1-2 sets
1. Foot Elevated Hamstring Stretch; 30 sec/side
1. Dynamic Couch Stretch; 30 sec/side
1. PVC Shoulder Extension Stretch; 30 sec

Tuesday, October 6th, 2026

Week 1 Day 2 - Persist PUMP CONDITION 3x

A) Active Recovery Work (Optional):
Goal: Complete 30 minutes of low-intensity steady-state movement today. You can get out for a 30-minute walk, hike on some moderate terrain, or if you like to bike or swim, have at it.

B) PERSIST RECOVERY MOBILITY SESSION:
Overhead
Sidelying Thoracic Rotation x 5 reps/side with 2-3 sec hold
T Spine Can Opener x 1-2 min
Prayer Stretch x 1-2 min
Prone Swimmer x 5 reps with 5 sec hold in the overhead position

Wednesday, October 7th, 2026

Week 1 Day 3 - Persist PUMP CONDITION 3x

A) Daily Focus Notes:
Close Grip Bench Press
Bringing your hands in shifts the work from the chest to the triceps and keeps your elbows tucked closer to your ribs. Expect to use less weight than your normal bench.. The last set is max reps at your first working weight, so leave something in the tank for it.

Short on time? Remove Strength Balance or Increasing Effort based on your goals.

B) Warmup (8 min):
2 min Cardio of Choice
3 Sets
1. 15 sec Cardio Sprint
1. Plank to Alternating Toe Touch; 6 reps/side
1. Half Kneeling Cable or Band Row; 10 reps/side

C) Strength Intensity 1 (15 min):
Close Grip Bench Press
4 Working Sets; rest 2 min
Warm-Up Set - 10 reps @20X1 Tempo - Easy
Working Set 1 - 8 reps @20X1 Tempo - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 8 reps @20X1 Tempo - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - 8 reps @20X1 Tempo - RPE 9
Working Set 4 - Max Unbroken reps @20X1 Tempo - RPE 10 - Set 1 weight.
RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

D) Strength Balance (8 min):
Supinated Strict Pullup
Every 75 sec x 6 sets
Set 1: 6 reps @20X0 Tempo - RPE 7
Set 2: 6 reps @20X0 Tempo - RPE 7
Set 3: 6 reps @20X0 Tempo - RPE 8
Set 4: 6 reps @20X0 Tempo - RPE 8
Set 5: 6 reps @20X0 Tempo - RPE 9
Set 6: 6 reps @20X0 Tempo - RPE 9
RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.
Loading Note: This is a high density format. Select assistance consistent with about a 12 rep max pullup. The format will remain the same for all odd weeks; aim to decrease assistance or improve quality throughout this training block.

E) Increasing Effort (15 min):
3 sets
10 Barbell Bent Over Row
rest 15 sec
30 sec Hollow Body Hold
rest 15 sec

15 Russian KB Swing (70/53)
rest 15 sec
Row 60 sec (must increase the effort of each row)
rest 90 sec
Effort Note: Increase row pace each set. Select a weight for the bent over row that will elicit a hypertrophy stimulus.

F) Cooldown (5 min):
1-2 sets
1. Scorpion Chest Stretch; 30 sec/side
1. Hip Sleeper Stretch; 30 sec/side
1. Passive Hang; 30 sec

Thursday, October 8th, 2026

Week 1 Day 4 - Persist PUMP CONDITION 3x

A) Active Recovery Work (Optional):
Goal: Complete 30 minutes of low-intensity steady-state movement today. You can get out for a 30-minute walk, hike on some moderate terrain, or if you like to bike or swim, have at it.

B) PERSIST RECOVERY MOBILITY SESSION:
Front Splits
Supine Hamstring Stretch x 1 min/side
Active Straight Leg Raise x 5 reps/side with 5 sec hold
Couch Stretch x 1-2 min/side
Front Split Progression x 10 reps/side
Front Split x 1-2 min/side

Friday, October 9th, 2026

Week 1 Day 5 - Persist PUMP CONDITION 3x

A) Daily Focus Notes:
Romanian Deadlift
The RDL is a hinge, not a squat. Push your hips back, keep the bar dragging close to your legs, and stop when you feel the stretch behind your knees. Three seconds down on every rep is what builds the hamstrings here, so do not rush the lowering.
Short on time? Remove Strength Balance or Aerobic Lower Body based on your goals.

B) Warmup (8 min):
2 min Cardio of Choice
3 Sets
1. Banded Goodmorning; 10-15 reps
1. Ring Y Row; 6-8 reps

C) Strength Intensity 1 (12 min):
Romanian Deadlift
3 Working Sets; rest 2-3 min
Warm-Up Set - 10 reps @30X0 Tempo - Easy
Working Set 1 - 8 reps @30X0 Tempo - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 8 reps @30X0 Tempo - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - 8 reps @30X0 Tempo - RPE 9
RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

D) Strength Balance (10 min):
3 sets
1. Barbell Z Press; 10 reps @21X1 Tempo
rest 30 sec
2. Dumbbell Front Raise; 10-12 reps @30X0 Tempo
rest 90 sec and back to 1.
Loading Note: Perform 1-2 warmup sets to determine starting weight. Aim for each set to be close to failure.

E) Aerobic Lower Body (15 min):
15 min Continuous Effort
Row 60 sec @ 60% effort
Row 30 sec @ 85% effort
20 Dumbbell Suitcase Walking Lunge (10/side) (50/35)
20 Tall Plank Knee to Elbow (10/side)
Effort Note: Perform at a sustainable pace. You may break up the weighted movements as needed to keep quality high. Make sure that you can sustain a good pace on the Row each round.

F) Cooldown (5 min):
1-2 sets
1. Seal Stretch; 30 sec
1. Pancake Stretch; 30 sec
1. Theraband Around the World; 10 reps

Saturday, October 10th, 2026

Week 1 Day 6 - Persist PUMP CONDITION 3x

A) Active Recovery Work (30 min):
Goal: Complete 30 minutes of low-intensity steady-state movement today. Go for a jog, hike, walk, ruck, bike, or swim. If you want a GYM OPTION, please use the following. Keep your heart rate in the Zone 2 range. That can be calculated roughly as 65-75% of your theoretical maximal HR (220-age).
Run/Bike/Row 30 sec @75% effort
rest 30 sec
x 8 Sets
2-3 Sets
Tall Plank Shoulder Taps x 20/side
30 sec Superman Hold
Run/Bike/Row 30 sec @75% effort
rest 30 sec
x 8 Sets
2-3 Sets
Quadruped Plank Shoulder Taps x 20/side
30 sec Swimmer Kicks
Run/Bike/Row 30 sec @75% effort
rest 30 sec
x 8 Sets

B) PERSIST RECOVERY MOBILITY SESSION (10 min):
Middle Splits
Half Split Hip Hinge x 5-7 reps/side
Weighted Butterfly Stretch x 2 min
Middle Split x 2 min
Middle Split Hip Hinge x 10 reps
Middle Split Knee Bends x 10 reps
Bottom of Squat Hold x 1-2 min

Sunday, October 11th, 2026

Week 1 Day 7 - Persist PUMP CONDITION 3x

Over the next six weeks I want to cover some of the smaller, less obvious things that quietly get in the way of progress. We're starting with effort calibration.

Not every session is meant to be a max effort. That's actually by design.

If you're following a program with RPE guidelines, those numbers are there for a reason. An RPE 6 day isn't a waste of time, it's building the aerobic base and movement quality that makes your harder days more effective. The problem is most people either ignore the easy days and go too hard, or they treat every session like a casual workout and never actually push when it counts.

An RPE 8 should feel hard. Not destroyed, but genuinely challenging. If you're hitting your sets and feel like you had a lot more in the tank, you probably left results on the table. Learning to calibrate your effort, to hold back when the program asks you to and actually push when it counts, is one of the most underrated skills in training.

Warmly,
Marcus

Perform

Monday, October 5th, 2026

Week 1 Day 1 - Persist PERFORM

A) Daily Focus Notes:
Back Squat
The back squat is the main lower body strength work this cycle. The 33X1 tempo means three seconds down, three seconds held in the bottom, then drive up fast and stand tall for one. That long pause kills the bounce, so every rep starts from a dead stop and the legs do all of it. Reps drop across the odd weeks, from five here to three and then two, so the weight climbs each time it comes back.
Short on time? Remove Strength Balance or Aerobic Lower Body based on your goals.

B) Warmup (8 min):
3 Rounds
1. 90 sec Cardio of Choice
1. Goblet Heel Sits; 10 reps
1. Ring Assisted Cossack Squat; 6 reps/side

C) Speed Strength - Clean (15-18 min):
Barbell Warm-up:
1-2 Sets (with Empty Barbell)
10 Romanian Deadlift
10 Strict Press
10 Front Squat
10 sec Squatting Quad Clean Grip Hold
10 sec Front Rack Hold
10 sec Front Squat Hold
Every 2:00-3:00 x 5 sets
3 No Feet Clean
rest until next 2:00
Sets 1-2: Easy
Sets 3-4: Moderate
Set 5: Challenging

D) Strength Intensity 1 (15 min):
Back Squat
3 Working Sets; rest 2-3 min
Warm-Up Set - 5 reps @33X1 Tempo - Easy
Warm-Up Set - 5 reps @33X1 Tempo - Easy
Working Set 1 - 5 reps @33X1 Tempo - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 5 reps @33X1 Tempo - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - 5 reps @33X1 Tempo - RPE 9
RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

E) Strength Balance (12 min):
3 sets
1. Assisted Nordic Hamstring Curl or BC Gliding Hamstring Curl; 8 reps @30X0 Tempo
rest 60 sec
2. Russian KB Swing; 10-15 reps
rest 60-90 sec and back to 1.
Loading Note:
Perform 1-2 warmup sets to determine starting weight. Aim for each set to be close to failure.

F) Aerobic Lower Body (15 min):
15 min Continuous Effort
Row 60 sec @ 60% effort

Row 30 sec @ 85% effort
20 Dumbbell Suitcase Walking Lunge (10/side) (50/35) (Male/Female)
20 GHD Sit Ups or Anchored Sit Ups
Effort Note:
Perform at a sustainable pace. You may break up the weighted movements as needed to keep quality high. Make sure that you can sustain a good pace on the Row each round.

G) Cooldown (5 min):
1-2 sets
1. Foot Elevated Hamstring Stretch; 30 sec/side
1. Dynamic Couch Stretch; 30 sec/side
1. Hip Sleeper Stretch; 30 sec/side

Tuesday, October 6th, 2026

Week 1 Day 2 - Persist PERFORM

A) Daily Focus Notes:
Close Grip Bench Press
The close grip bench press is the main pressing lift this cycle. Bringing the hands inside shoulder width shifts work off the chest and onto the triceps, and it keeps the elbows tucked, which is easier on the shoulders. The 20X1 tempo means two seconds down, no pause on the chest, then drive and hold one second at the top. The last set is max unbroken reps at your Set 1 weight, so leave something in the tank for it.
Short on time? Remove Strength Balance or Press Core Conditioning based on your goals.

B) Warmup (8 min):
2 min Cardio of Choice
3 Sets
1. 15 sec Cardio Sprint
1. Plank to Alternating Toe Touch; 6 reps/side
1. Half Kneeling Cable or Band Row; 10 reps/side

C) Gymnastics HOT START (12 min):
4-5 Rounds @ sustainable pace
Row 250m/200m (Male/Female)
3-5 Bar Muscle Up
10-15 Tuck Ups
Loading Note:
If you need to regress the muscle up, perform the following:

3-5 Burpee Strict Pullup
Progression Note:
This conditioning piece is performed first in order to be fresh while performing the gymnastics movements. The rowing should be at a pace that allows you to be fresh for the muscle up.

D) Strength Intensity 1 (12 min):
Close Grip Bench Press
4 Working Sets; rest 2 min
Warm-Up Set - 10 reps @20X1 Tempo - Easy
Working Set 1 - 8 reps @20X1 Tempo - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 8 reps @20X1 Tempo - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - 8 reps @20X1 Tempo - RPE 9
Working Set 4 - Max Unbroken reps @20X1 Tempo - RPE 10 - Set 1 weight.
RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

E) Strength Balance (12 min):
3 sets
1. Incline Dumbbell Chest Fly; 10 reps @30X0 Tempo
rest 30 sec
2. Barbell Skullcrushers; 10 reps @30X0 Tempo
rest 90 sec and back to 1.
Loading Note:
Perform 1-2 warmup sets to determine starting weight. Aim for each set to be close to failure.

F) Press Core Conditioning (15 min):
For Time
8-10-12-10-8
Toes to Bar or Hanging Knee Tucks
Dumbbell Bench Press @30X0 Tempo
*At the end of each round, complete 10 Burpees
*15 min CAP
Effort Note:
Perform this at a consistent pace. Select a weight that you could perform for 15 reps @RPE 8-9.

G) Cooldown (5 min):
1-2 sets
1. Scorpion Chest Stretch; 30 sec/side
1. Banded Single Arm Behind the Back Stretch; 30 sec/side
1. Passive Hang; 30 sec

Wednesday, October 7th, 2026

Week 1 Day 3 - Persist PERFORM

A) Daily Focus Notes:
Romanian Deadlift
The Romanian deadlift is the main hinge this cycle. Start standing, push the hips back with a soft knee, and lower the bar down the thighs for three full seconds until you feel the hamstrings stretch, then stand tall. The bar never touches the floor, so the hamstrings stay under tension for the whole set. Reps sit at eight across the odd weeks and step down to seven then six, so the weight climbs each time it returns.
Short on time? Remove Strength Balance or Power Conditioning based on your goals.

B) Warmup (8 min):
2 min Cardio of Choice
3 Sets
1. Banded Goodmorning; 10-15 reps
1. Dumbbell Chainsaw Row; 6-8 reps/side

C) Speed Strength - Snatch (15-18 min):
Barbell Warm-up:
1-2 Sets (with Empty Barbell)
10 Snatch Grip Romanian Deadlift
10 BTN Snatch Press or BTN Snatch Push Press
10 Overhead Squat
10 sec Squatting Quad Snatch Grip Hold
10 sec Snatch Grip Overhead Hold
10 sec Overhead Squat Hold
Every 2:00 x 5 sets
3 Muscle Snatch
rest until the next 2:00
Sets 1-2: Easy
Sets 3-4: Moderate
Set 5: Challenging

D) Strength Intensity 1 (12 min):
Romanian Deadlift
3 Working Sets; rest 2-3 min
Warm-Up Set - 10 reps @30X0 Tempo - Easy
Working Set 1 - 8 reps @30X0 Tempo - RPE 7

Working Set 2 - 8 reps @30X0 Tempo - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - 8 reps @30X0 Tempo - RPE 9
RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

E) Strength Balance (8 min):
Supinated Strict Pullup
Every 75 sec x 6 sets
Set 1: 6 reps @20X0 Tempo - RPE 7
Set 2: 6 reps @20X0 Tempo - RPE 7
Set 3: 6 reps @20X0 Tempo - RPE 8
Set 4: 6 reps @20X0 Tempo - RPE 8
Set 5: 6 reps @20X0 Tempo - RPE 9
Set 6: 6 reps @20X0 Tempo - RPE 9
RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.
Loading Note:
This is a high density format. Select assistance consistent with about a 12 rep max pullup. The format will remain the same for all odd weeks, aim to decrease assistance or improve quality throughout this training block.

F) Power Conditioning (13 min):
Every 2:30 x 5 sets
20 sec Bike SPRINT
12 Single Arm Alternating Devils Press (6/side)
rest until the start of the next 2:30
Effort Note:
*Use the following guide in order to approach each set with escalating effort on the Bike.
Set 1 - Moderate Effort - RPE 7-8
Set 2 - Hard Effort - RPE 8-9
Sets 3-5 - Maximal Effort - RPE 9-10

G) Cooldown (5 min):
1-2 sets
1. Cat Cow; 5 reps
1. Childs Pose Lat Stretch; 30 sec/side
1. Downdog to Updog; 5 reps with 2-3 sec hold in each position
1. Pigeon Stretch; 30-60 sec/side

Thursday, October 8th, 2026

Week 1 Day 4 - Persist PERFORM

A) Active Recovery Work (30-40 min):
Goal: Complete 30 minutes of low-intensity steady-state movement today. Go for a jog, hike, walk, ruck, bike, or swim. If you want a GYM OPTION, please use the following. You should keep your heart rate in the Zone 2 range. That can be calculated roughly as 65-75% of your theoretical maximal HR (220-age).
Run/Bike/Row 30 sec @75% effort
rest 30 sec
x 8 Sets
2-3 Sets
1. Tall Plank Shoulder Taps x 20/side
1. 30 sec Superman Hold
Run/Bike/Row 30 sec @75% effort
rest 30 sec
x 8 Sets
2-3 Sets
1. Quadruped Plank Shoulder Taps x 20/side
1. 30 sec Swimmer Kicks
Run/Bike/Row 30 sec @75% effort
rest 30 sec
x 8 Sets

B) PERSIST RECOVERY MOBILITY SESSION (12 min):
Front Splits
Supine Hamstring Stretch x 1 min/side
Active Straight Leg Raise x 5 reps/side with 5 sec hold
Couch Stretch x 1-2 min/side
Front Split Progression x 10 reps/side
Front Split x 1-2 min/side

Friday, October 9th, 2026

Week 1 Day 5 - Persist PERFORM

A) Daily Focus Notes:
Suitcase Rear Foot Elevated Split Squat
The suitcase rear foot elevated split squat is the main single leg strength work on Fridays. A dumbbell hanging at each side keeps the torso upright and drives almost all the load onto the front leg while the back foot only balances. Keep the front heel planted and lower for two seconds on every rep. Reps step down from twelve to ten to eight per side as the weight climbs each set.

Short on time? Remove Strength Balance or Barbell Cycling based on your goals.

B) Warmup (8 min):
2 min Cardio of Choice
3 Sets
1. 15 sec Cardio Sprint
1. Single Leg Dumbbell Glute Bridge; 10 reps/side
1. Deficit Dumbbell Sumo Deadlift; 10 reps

C) Kettlebell and Plyometric HOT START (9 min):
Every 60 sec x 9 min
Minute 1) 5 Right Arm Kettlebell Snatch + 5 Right Arm Kettlebell Reverse Lunge
Minute 2) 5 Left Arm Kettlebell Snatch + 5 Left Arm Kettlebell Reverse Lunge
Minute 3) 10 Diagonal Skater Jump (5/side)

D) Strength Intensity 1 (15 min):
Suitcase Rear Foot Elevated Split Squat
3 Working Sets; rest 2-3 min
Warm-Up Set - 10 reps/side @20X0 Tempo - Easy
Working Set 1 - 12 reps/side @20X0 Tempo - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 10 reps/side @20X0 Tempo - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - 8 reps/side @20X0 Tempo - RPE 9
RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

E) Strength Balance (10 min):
3 sets
1. Goblet Tall Kneel to Stand; 10 reps (5/side alternating)
directly into
1. Goblet Curtsy Squat; 10 reps (5/side alternating)
rest 90 sec and back to 1.
Loading Note:
Perform 1-2 warmup sets to determine starting weight. Aim for each set to be close to failure.

F) Barbell Cycling (12 min):
3 sets @ High Effort
Bike 15/12 Calories (Male/Female)
Power Snatch x 10 (95/65)
rest 2 min between sets
Effort Note:

With each set increase your speed on the Bike and attempt to cycle the barbell with greater efficiency and/or speed.

G) Cooldown (5 min):
1-2 sets
1. Seal Stretch; 30 sec
1. Pancake Stretch; 30 sec
1. Horse Stance Pulse; 30 sec

Saturday, October 10th, 2026

Week 1 Day 6 - Persist PERFORM

A) Daily Focus Notes:
Barbell Z Press
The barbell Z press is the main overhead lift this cycle. Sitting on the floor with the legs straight out takes away every bit of leg drive and any chance to lean back, so the shoulders and the midline do all the work. The 20X1 tempo means two seconds down, no pause, then press and hold tall for one at the top. The last set is max unbroken reps at your Set 1 weight, so save something for it. Short on time? Remove Strength Balance or Functional Pump Conditioning based on your goals.

B) Warmup (8 min):
2 min Cardio of Choice
3 Sets
1. Prone Behind the Neck Press; 6-8 reps
1. Ring Y Row; 6-8 reps

C) Upper HOT START (10 min):
4 Rounds - Increasing your bike pace on each round
15/12 Calories Bike (Male/Female)
10 Pushup
15-25 sec Supinated Pull Up Isometric
Intention Note:
Start easy and gradually build up speed and intensity.

D) Strength Intensity 1 (15 min):
Barbell Z Press
4 Working Sets; rest 2 min
Warm-Up Set - 10 reps @20X1 Tempo - Easy
Working Set 1 - 8 reps @20X1 Tempo - RPE 7

Working Set 2 - 8 reps @20X1 Tempo - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - 8 reps @20X1 Tempo - RPE 9
Working Set 4 - Max Unbroken reps @20X1 Tempo - RPE 10 - Set 1 weight.
RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

E) Strength Balance (10 min):
3 sets
1. Inchworm Push Up; 6-8 reps
rest 30 sec
2. Dumbbell Front Raise; 10-12 reps @30X0 Tempo
rest 90 sec and back to 1.
Loading Note:
Perform 1-2 warmup sets to determine starting weight. Aim for each set to be close to failure.

F) Functional Pump Conditioning (12 min):
12 min AMRAP @ sustainable effort
Bike 60 sec
10 Alternating Kettlebell Gorilla Row (5/side) (44/26) (Male/Female)
10 Strict Kettlebell Press (44/26)
10 Kettlebell Push Press (44/26)
20m Quadruped Crawl
Effort Note:
Perform a sustainable pace with consistent or very gradual increase in heart rate or breathing for all 12 minutes.

G) Cooldown (5 min):
1-2 sets
1. Theraband Around the World; 6-10 reps
1. Supinated Passive Hang; 30 sec
1. PVC Shoulder Extension Stretch; 30-60 sec

Sunday, October 11th, 2026

Week 1 Day 7 - Persist PERFORM

Over the next six weeks I want to cover some of the smaller, less obvious things that quietly get in the way of progress. We're starting with effort calibration.

Not every session is meant to be a max effort. That's actually by design.

If you're following a program with RPE guidelines, those numbers are there for a reason. An RPE 6 day isn't a waste of time, it's building the aerobic base and movement quality that makes your harder days more effective. The problem is most people either ignore the easy days and go too hard, or they treat every session like a casual workout and never actually push when it counts.

An RPE 8 should feel hard. Not destroyed, but genuinely challenging. If you're hitting your sets and feel like you had a lot more in the tank, you probably left results on the table. Learning to calibrate your effort, to hold back when the program asks you to and actually push when it counts, is one of the most underrated skills in training.

Warmly,
Marcus

Warmly,
Marcus

Minimalist

Monday, October 5th, 2026

Week 1 Day 1 - Persist MINIMALIST

A) Daily Focus Notes:
Dumbbell Suitcase Cyclist Squat
The cyclist squat raises your heels, which lets your knees travel forward and puts almost all the work on your quads. Holding a dumbbell in each hand at your sides keeps your torso tall without loading your shoulders. The 33X1 tempo means three seconds down, three seconds held at the bottom, then stand up fast and squeeze for one at the top. That long pause takes away the bounce, so every rep starts from a dead stop.
Short on time? Remove Strength Balance or Aerobic Lower Body based on your goals.

B) Warmup (8 min):
3 Rounds
1. 90 sec Cardio of Choice
1. Goblet Heel Sits; 10 reps
1. Ring Assisted Cossack Squat; 6 reps/side

C) Strength Intensity (12 min):
Dumbbell Suitcase Cyclist Squat
3 Working Sets; rest 2-3 min
Warm-Up Set - 8 reps @33X1 Tempo - Easy
Working Set 1 - 8 reps @33X1 Tempo - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 8 reps @33X1 Tempo - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - 8 reps @33X1 Tempo - RPE 9
RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

D) Strength Balance (12 min):
3 sets
1. Slide Hamstring Curls; 10-12 reps @30X0 Tempo or Hamstring Plank; 30 sec
rest 60 sec
2. Single Arm Dumbbell Swing; 8-10 reps/side
rest 60-90 sec and back to 1.
Loading Note:
Perform 1-2 warmup sets to determine starting weight. Aim for each set to be close to failure.

E) Aerobic Lower Body (15 min):
15 min Continuous Effort
200m Run
20 Dumbbell Suitcase Walking Lunge (50/35) (Male/Female)
20 Tall Plank Knee to Elbow (10/side)
Effort Note:
Perform at a sustainable pace. You may break up the weighted movements as needed to keep quality high. Make sure that you can sustain a good pace on the Run each round.

F) Cooldown (5 min):
1-2 sets
1. Foot Elevated Hamstring Stretch; 30 sec/side
1. Dynamic Couch Stretch; 30 sec/side
1. Hip Sleeper Stretch; 30 sec/side

Tuesday, October 6th, 2026

Week 1 Day 2 - Persist MINIMALIST

A) Daily Focus Notes:
Seated Alternating Dumbbell Press

Pressing one arm at a time means your midsection has to stop you tipping toward the working side, so you train shoulders and core in the same set. Sitting down takes your legs out of it, which makes the press honest. The 20X1 tempo means two seconds down, no pause, then press and hold tall for one at the top. The last set is max unbroken reps at your Set 1 weight, so leave something for it. Short on time? Remove Strength Balance or Press Core Conditioning based on your goals.

B) Warmup (8 min):
2 min Cardio of Choice
3 Sets
1. 15 sec Cardio Sprint
1. Plank to Alternating Toe Touch; 6 reps/side
1. Half Kneeling Cable or Band Row; 10 reps/side

C) Strength Intensity (15 min):
Seated Alternating Dumbbell Press
4 Working Sets; rest 2 min
Warm-Up Set - 8 reps/side @20X1 Tempo - Easy
Working Set 1 - 8 reps/side @20X1 Tempo - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 8 reps/side @20X1 Tempo - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - 8 reps/side @20X1 Tempo - RPE 9
Working Set 4 - Max Unbroken reps @20X1 Tempo - RPE 10 - Set 1 weight.
RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

D) Strength Balance (10 min):
3 sets
1. Incline Dumbbell Chest Fly; 10 reps @30X0 Tempo
rest 30 sec
2. Dumbbell Skullcrushers; 10 reps @30X0 Tempo
rest 90 sec and back to 1.
Loading Note:
Perform 1-2 warmup sets to determine starting weight. Aim for each set to be close to failure.

E) Press Core Conditioning (15 min):
For Time
8-10-12-10-8
Toes to Bar or Hanging Knee Tucks
Dumbbell Bench Press @30X0 Tempo
*At the end of each round, complete 10 Burpees
*15 min CAP

Effort Note:
Perform this at a consistent pace. Select a weight that you could perform for 15 reps @RPE 8-9.

F) Cooldown (5 min):
1-2 sets
1. Scorpion Chest Stretch; 30 sec/side
1. Banded Single Arm Behind the Back Stretch; 30 sec/side
1. Passive Hang; 30 sec

Wednesday, October 7th, 2026

Week 1 Day 3 - Persist MINIMALIST

A) OPTIONAL - Active Recovery Work (30 min):
Goal: Complete 30 minutes of low-intensity steady-state movement today. You can get out for a 30-minute walk, hike on some moderate terrain, or if you like to bike or swim, have at it.

B) PERSIST RECOVERY MOBILITY SESSION (10 min):
Overhead
Sidelying Thoracic Rotation x 5 reps/side with 2-3 sec hold
T Spine Can Opener x 1-2 min
Prayer Stretch x 1-2 min
Prone Swimmer x 5 reps with 5 sec hold in the overhead position

Thursday, October 8th, 2026

Week 1 Day 4 - Persist MINIMALIST

A) Daily Focus Notes:
Dumbbell Romanian Deadlift
The RDL is a hinge, not a squat. Push your hips back, keep the dumbbells dragging close to your legs, and stop when you feel the stretch behind your knees. Three seconds down on every rep is what builds the hamstrings here, so do not rush the lowering.
Short on time? Remove Strength Balance or Anaerobic Power Conditioning based on your goals.

B) Warmup (8 min):
2 min Cardio of Choice
3 Sets
1. 15 sec Cardio Sprint
1. Single Leg Dumbbell Glute Bridge; 10 reps/side

1. Deficit Dumbbell Sumo Deadlift; 10 reps

C) Strength Intensity (12 min):
Dumbbell Romanian Deadlift
3 Working Sets; rest 2-3 min
Warm-Up Set - 10 reps @30X0 Tempo - Easy
Working Set 1 - 8 reps @30X0 Tempo - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 8 reps @30X0 Tempo - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - 8 reps @30X0 Tempo - RPE 9
RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

D) Strength Balance (12 min):
3 sets
1. Goblet Tall Kneel to Stand; 10 reps (5/side alternating)
directly into
1. Goblet Curtsy Squat; 10 reps (5/side alternating)
rest 90 sec and back to 1.
Loading Note:
Perform 1-2 warmup sets to determine starting weight. Aim for each set to be close to failure.

E) Anaerobic Power Conditioning (15 min):
5 sets
10 Box Jump Step Down
10 Single Arm Alternating Devils Press (5/side)
10 Skater Jumps (5/side)
rest walk 90 sec
Effort Note:
The goal is maximal output, do NOT pace. All 5 sets should be at the same maximal effort, so take the full rest walk between them.

F) Cooldown (5 min):
1-2 sets
1. Seal Stretch; 30 sec
1. Pancake Stretch; 30 sec
1. Horse Stance Pulse; 30 sec

Friday, October 9th, 2026

Week 1 Day 5 - Persist MINIMALIST

A) Daily Focus Notes:
Supinated Strict Pullup
The pullup is the main strength lift on Fridays, not an accessory. Six sets go every seventy five seconds, so the clock decides your rest and it feels shorter every set. Palms face you on the odd weeks, which brings your biceps in and usually buys you a few more honest reps. Use only as much assistance as you need to hit six clean reps with a two second lower on every one.
Short on time? Remove Strength Balance or Functional Pump Conditioning based on your goals.

B) Warmup (8 min):
2 min Cardio of Choice
3 Sets
1. Prone Behind the Neck Press; 6-8 reps
1. Ring Y Row; 6-8 reps

C) Strength Intensity (8 min):
Supinated Strict Pullup
Every 75 sec x 6 sets
Set 1: 6 reps @20X0 Tempo - RPE 7
Set 2: 6 reps @20X0 Tempo - RPE 7
Set 3: 6 reps @20X0 Tempo - RPE 8
Set 4: 6 reps @20X0 Tempo - RPE 8
Set 5: 6 reps @20X0 Tempo - RPE 9
Set 6: 6 reps @20X0 Tempo - RPE 9
RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.
Loading Note:
This is a high density format. Select assistance consistent with about a 12 rep max pullup. The format will remain the same for all odd weeks, aim to decrease assistance or improve quality throughout this training block.

D) Strength Balance (10 min):
3 sets
1. Inchworm Pushup; 6-8 reps
rest 30 sec
2. Dumbbell Front Raise; 10-12 reps @30X0 Tempo
rest 90 sec and back to 1.
Loading Note:
Perform 1-2 warmup sets to determine starting weight. Aim for each set to be close to failure.

E) Functional Pump Conditioning (12 min):

12 min AMRAP @ sustainable effort
Run 60 sec
10 Alternating Dumbbell Gorilla Row (5/side)
5 Strict Dumbbell Press
5 Dumbbell Push Press
20m Quadruped Crawl
Effort Note:
Perform a sustainable pace with consistent or very gradual increase in heart rate or breathing for all 12 minutes.

F) Cooldown (5 min):
1-2 sets
1. Theraband Around the World; 6-10 reps
1. Supinated Passive Hang; 30 sec
1. PVC Shoulder Extension Stretch; 30-60 sec

Saturday, October 10th, 2026

Week 1 Day 6 - Persist MINIMALIST

A) OPTIONAL - Active Recovery Work (30 min):
Goal: Complete 30 minutes of low-intensity steady-state movement today. Go for a jog, hike, walk, ruck, bike, or swim. If you want a GYM OPTION, please use the following. You should keep your heart rate in the Zone 2 range. That can be calculated roughly as 65-75% of your theoretical maximal HR (220-age).
Run/Bike/Row 30 sec @75% effort
rest 30 sec
x 8 Sets
2-3 Sets
Tall Plank Shoulder Taps x 20/side
30 sec Superman Hold
Run/Bike/Row 30 sec @75% effort
rest 30 sec
x 8 Sets
2-3 Sets
Quadruped Plank Shoulder Taps x 20/side
30 sec Swimmer Kicks
Run/Bike/Row 30 sec @75% effort
rest 30 sec
x 8 Sets

B) PERSIST RECOVERY MOBILITY SESSION (10 min):
Front Splits
Supine Hamstring Stretch x 1 min/side
Active Straight Leg Raise x 5 reps/side with 5 sec hold
Couch Stretch x 1-2 min/side
Front Split Progression x 10 reps/side
Front Split x 1-2 min/side

Sunday, October 11th, 2026

Week 1 Day 7 - Persist MINIMALIST

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